

Richard Donovan

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EXPERIENCE

01/2007 - Present	Applied Scientist Blue Orbit Labs ■ Ran A/B tests across 3 model variants; the winning variant added an estimated \$30k in annual revenue. ■ Built an end-to-end training pipeline on Spark, cutting retraining from days to 6 hours. ■ Lifted recommendation click-through by 18% through feature engineering and retraining cadence in Pandas.
12/2004 - 10/2006	Data Scientist Shopify ■ Built the feature store that 3 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic. ■ Translated ambiguous business questions into a modelling roadmap with product and finance stakeholders.
12/2001 - 10/2004	MLOps Engineer Lumen Works ■ Developed an NLP classification system in TensorFlow reaching 90% F1, replacing a manual review queue.
06/2001 - 12/2001	Applied Scientist Intel ■ Cut inference cost by 30% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on GCP.
09/2000 - 04/2001	Data Scientist Summit Digital ■ Mentored 20 analysts moving into modelling work, with weekly paper reading and code review.

QUALIFICATIONS

PhD, Software Engineering

Garciaberg Institute of Technology | 2000

Bachelor, Electrical Engineering

New Tiffanyburgh National University | 1992 - 1995

KEY SKILLS

Airflow (19 yr exp), Spark (1 yr exp), MLflow (3 yr exp), AWS (8 yr exp), NumPy (3 yr exp), PyTorch (16 yr exp), Scikit-learn (12 yr exp), Pandas (17 yr exp), TensorFlow (8 yr exp), Snowflake (4 yr exp), Kafka (19 yr exp), Django (12 yr exp), GCP (2 yr exp), Sketch (25 yr exp), Node.js (23 yr exp), Prometheus (9 yr exp)

OPEN SOURCE

Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on Pandas.

Conference talk

Spoke on Sketch in production at a regional meetup, ~10 attendees.

CERTIFICATIONS

Tableau Desktop Specialist — Tableau, 2018

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate — Amazon Web Services, 2023

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) — Microsoft, 2022

PUBLICATIONS

"Measuring the cost of technical debt in delivery throughput" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2001.